

## **Foreign Missions Center at the Former Walter Reed Army Medical Center Final Environmental Impact Statement**

This final document was made available to the public in November of 2017, the draft was made public in March of 2017, and the project began in the spring of 2015. The clip included here is the Executive Summary which I cultivated from the main body of the 238 page report. I was responsible for the layout in InDesign, the Executive Summary, the Abstract, and the editing and proofing. In late 2015 the overall plan for the project was changed and a large chunk of the original project area was reallocated for a different purpose. The substantial reduction in overall acreage required that we create a supplemental environmental impact statement (EIS) for the new plans. Therefore, this project included various tech reports, a draft EIS (DEIS), a supplemental DEIS (DSEIS), and a Final EIS over a period of nearly three years.

# ***Foreign Missions Center at the Former Walter Reed Army Medical Center***

## **Final Environmental Impact Statement**

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**U.S. Department of State  
November 2017  
Washington, D.C.  
DOS-DC-EIS-14-01-F**



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The U.S. Department of State (DOS) proposes to develop a Foreign Missions Center (FMC) on the northwest portion of the former Walter Reed Army Medical Center on 16th Street in Northwest Washington, DC. DOS is seeking to redevelop 31.7 acres for the construction of new chancery buildings by foreign governments. DOS acquired the land under the Foreign Missions Act of 1982 (U.S.C. 4301-4316), which facilitates the conduct of diplomacy and consular operations between the United States and foreign governments.

This Final Environmental Impact Statement (FEIS) was prepared in accordance with the National Environmental Policy Act 42 U.S.C. 4321-4347 and examines the potential environmental impacts of a “no-action” alternative and seven alternatives to develop the FMC. The purpose of this FEIS is to provide DOS, other agencies, and the public with a full accounting of the potential environmental impacts prior to decision-making. Subsequent to the publication of the original Draft Environmental Impact Statement, the total acreage of the land available for transfer from the Army to DOS was reduced from 43.5 to 31.7 acres through the National Defense Authorization Act of 2015. Because of the change in the proposed action, DOS prepared a Supplemental Draft Environmental Impact Statement, revised to become this FEIS, to describe the new preferred alternative, and evaluate any change in potential impacts from the reduction in size of the proposed action. It serves as the primary document to facilitate review of the proposed action by federal, District of Columbia, and local agencies, and the public.

After careful consideration of a range of reasonable alternatives, DOS has identified an action alternative that it believes would best fulfill the purpose and needs of its statutory mission and responsibilities, and has the least adverse environmental impact.

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Adam H. Bodner, Director  
Office of Real Property Management  
U.S. Department of State

November, 8, 2017

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## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Department of State (DOS) is the federal executive agency responsible for the international relations of the United States. DOS has a number of domestic and international responsibilities associated with the establishment and operation of foreign missions in the United States. DOS is responsible for assisting foreign missions to identify properties on which they may locate and operate chanceries in the United States.

The availability of adequate space for the construction and operation of chanceries by foreign missions has been a long-standing challenge in Washington, DC. In anticipation of needing to develop another site similar to the International Chancery Center (ICC), DOS undertook a multiyear evaluation of available land parcels within Washington, DC and concluded that the former Walter Reed Army Medical Center (WRAMC) site was best suited to support the Foreign Missions Center (FMC) concept.

## PROJECT OVERVIEW

### Proposed Action

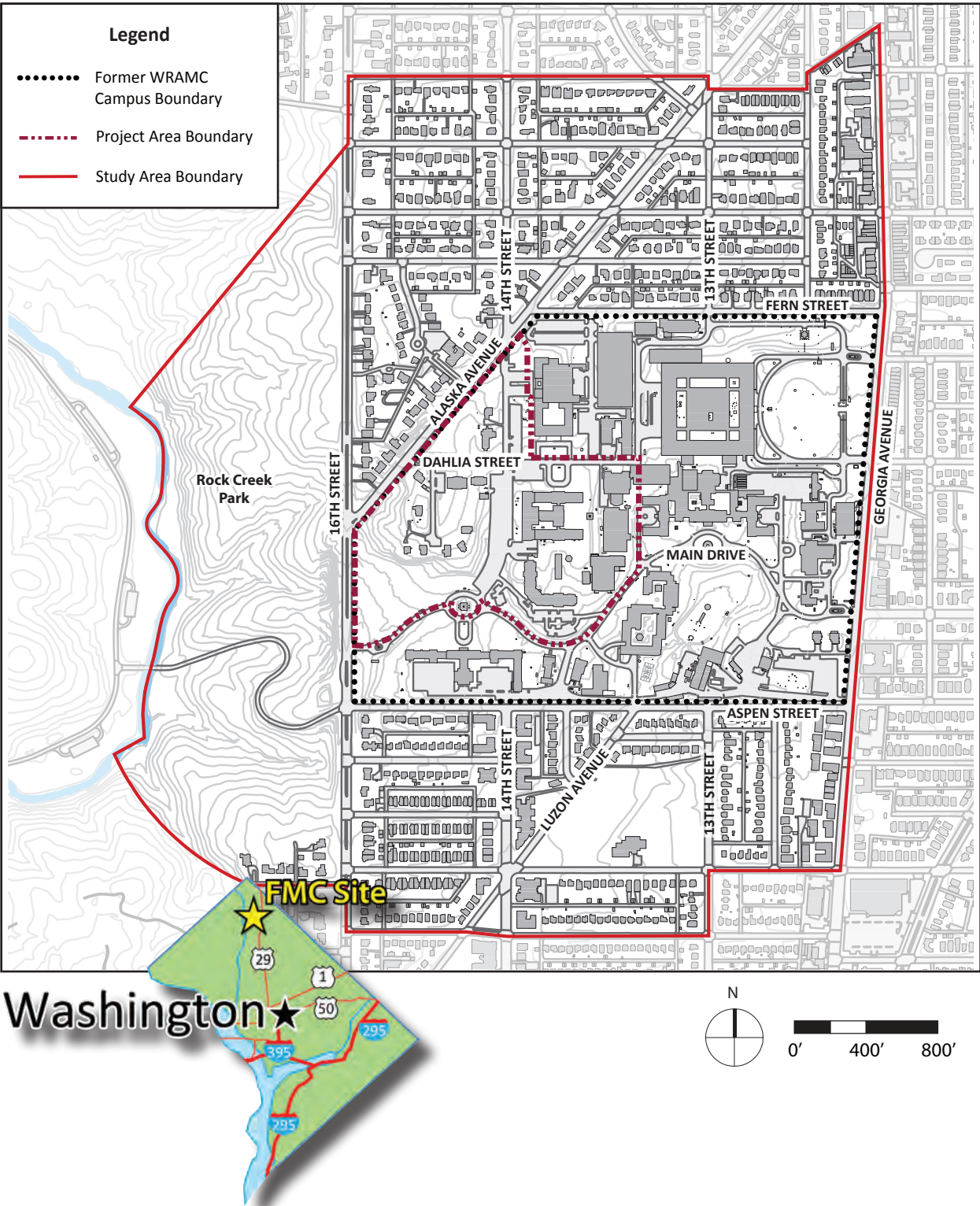
The proposed action is to prepare a master plan for the long-term development of a FMC on approximately 31.7 acres of the former WRAMC site at 16th Street, between Aspen Street and Alaska Avenue in the District of Columbia (Exhibit S.1). The proposed action consists of assignment of federal land to foreign missions for the purpose of constructing and operating new chancery facilities. DOS would manage the FMC, including maintaining common areas.

The proposed FMC was conceptually planned to complement the campus character and be consistent with current and future adjacent land uses by:

1. Designing each lot access point to be placed on internal roadways of the campus;
2. Allowing public access to the proposed streets and parks within the site;
3. Developing a reuse program for one historic building and maximizing the potential for reuse of other historic buildings;
4. Maintaining a greater than 30-foot setback between the southern boundary of the site and historic Main Drive;
5. Emphasizing vehicular and pedestrian connections between the DOS portion and the adjacent land uses; and
6. Maintaining a 50-foot vegetated buffer on the west boundary of the site, and preserving the tree canopy to the maximum extent possible.

DOS anticipates a maximum of 15 chanceries will be established at the FMC. Countries would have the option to combine lots if desired. The lots would range in lot size. The lots south of

Exhibit S.1 - Study Area



Dahlia Street are envisioned by DOS to be larger with the expectation that foreign missions may construct several buildings, creating a compound. The lots along and north of Dahlia Street are envisioned to be closer together, resulting in a denser development. Each foreign mission would be responsible for meeting parking needs (employee and visitor) on its individual lot. On-street parking would not be permitted. Specific lot development guidelines (such as minimal building setbacks, building lot coverage, maximum building height, and floor-to-area ratio) would be dependent upon the lot's location.

The primary vehicle entrance would be at the intersection of Main Drive and 14th Street. Other vehicle entrances would be at Alaska Avenue and Dahlia Street, and Dahlia Street. Streets internal to the FMC would be private, and owned and maintained by the federal government. Primary streets (14th Street and Dahlia Street) would consist of one travel lane and one bike lane in each direction. Wider sidewalks would be located on both sides of primary streets. Intersections would be controlled with stop signs. The FMC will be open to public transit.

The existing historic perimeter fence along the 16th Street and Alaska Avenue frontages would be retained. Each foreign mission would be responsible for the perimeter security of its individual lot. The design guidelines state that the maximum height for private frontage fences on individual lots shall be no greater than three meters above the finish grade of the sidewalk (Appendix C).

Utilities at the FMC would include domestic water, stormwater drainage and treatment, sanitary sewerage, data and telecommunications, electrical power, natural gas, and street lighting. The stormwater system for roads would connect to the District of Columbia system. Utilities would be underground and utility service would be provided to each lot.

Foreign missions would fully fund DOS's upfront infrastructure development costs through the revenue generated from the assignment of lots. The proposed action would be built over approximately 15-20 years.

## **Purpose**

The purpose of the proposed action is to prepare a master plan for the long-term development of a FMC, under authorities of the Foreign Missions Act of 1982 (FMA), on the site of the former WRAMC in the District of Columbia. The master plan is intended to guide the development of a cohesive campus by establishing design and land-use planning principles for the construction of new buildings, roadways, open green space, and utilities, while minimizing environmental impacts.

## **Need**

The need for the proposed action is based on increased and high demand for foreign mission facilities in the District of Columbia, a lack of large sites for foreign mission development or redevelopment in the District, and the need for land to use in property exchanges with other countries. This scarcity has impacted DOS's ability to acquire properties in foreign nations.



DOS has an urgent need to meet the demand from foreign missions for modern and secure facilities within the nation's capital. World events such as the collapses in the 1990s of both the Soviet Union and Yugoslavia resulted in the creation of 21 new countries. Further, the rapid growth and prominence of countries such as Brazil, China, India, and Vietnam have had a significant impact on the diplomatic presence of such governments, as well as on DOS's reciprocal presence and operations in those countries.

In accordance with the FMA, DOS enters into property exchange agreements with other countries, whereby property is provided to foreign governments for the establishment of missions in exchange for DOS receiving similar property within their countries. In addition to the FMA, the 1961 Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations mandates that signatory nations, including the United States, must facilitate the acquisition of premises for foreign missions. However, the lack of suitable land for development or redevelopment and a full ICC have inhibited DOS's ability to reciprocate.

DOS has a need to resolve stalled attempts to acquire property in certain countries to construct adequate and secure facilities for the conduct of American diplomacy and consular operations.

## **SCOPING AND EARLY COORDINATION**

Scoping letters were mailed in June 2012 to agencies with jurisdiction over features in the study area or an interest in the study and its results, in accordance with the procedural provisions of National Environmental Policy Act and the DOS's requirements and policies for early coordination.

A public scoping meeting was held July 19, 2012, in the District of Columbia. It was an open house with displays, a presentation, and an area for public comments and questions to be submitted for consideration in the planning of the proposed action and preparation of the Environmental Impact Statement (EIS). During the 30-day scoping period, the key issues of concern identified by the public were the preservation of trees and open space, traffic impacts, noise impacts, historic preservation and security.

The master plan study was developed in conjunction with federal and district agencies with jurisdiction over features or an interest in the study area through a series of meetings.

In compliance with Section 106 of the National Historic Preservation Act of 1966 (NHPA), consulting parties were identified to consult on potential effects to historic resources and measures to minimize and mitigate them. Consulting parties included the District of Columbia Historic Preservation Office (DC-HPO), National Capital Planning Commission (NCPC), Advisory Council on Historic Preservation (ACHP), National Park Service - Rock Creek Park, The Committee of 100 on the Federal City, and The Alliance to Preserve the Civil War Defenses of Washington (APCWDW).

## **ALTERNATIVES RETAINED FOR FURTHER CONSIDERATION**

The DOS identified, developed, and analyzed the No Action Alternative and seven action alternatives that could potentially satisfy the proposed action's purpose and needs. Alternatives were developed through collaborative planning and design work sessions with other federal and district agencies with direct or indirect jurisdiction over the proposed action, or an interest or special expertise, at key milestones to receive feedback and suggestions for improvement.

Components common to the action alternatives consisted of cost-neutral funding, a minimum 50-year design life for utilities, on-lot stormwater management, parking considerations, and street design. Site and individual lot development parameters (size, floor area ratio, building coverage, and height restrictions) developed for each campus zone did not vary between the action alternatives. Under the action alternatives, the existing historic perimeter fence would be retained and the existing landscape on the west boundary enhanced to create a vegetated buffer, and maximize the tree canopy in this area. Access points for individual lots would be placed on internal roadways.

During the alternatives development process, six action alternatives were considered and four were dismissed. The Draft Environmental Impact Statement (DEIS) Preferred Action Alternative and the No Action Alternative were retained for further consideration and more detailed analysis. Subsequent to the publication of the original DEIS, the total acreage of the land available for transfer from the Army to DOS was reduced from 43.5 to 31.7 acres through the National Defense Authorization Act of 2015. DOS, in coordination with U.S. Commission of Fine Arts, NCPC, DC-HPO, and District of Columbia Department of Transportation (DDOT), then developed Alternative 7, which has been identified as the Final Draft Environmental Impact Statement (FEIS) Selected Action Alternative.

DOS believes the Selected Action Alternative would best fulfill its statutory mission and responsibilities, while giving consideration to economic, environmental, technical, and other factors. In identifying its FEIS Selected Action Alternative, DOS has identified the environmentally preferable alternative because it best meets the purpose and needs of the study; causes the least damage to the biological and physical environment; and best protects, preserves, and enhances the historic, cultural, and natural resources of the study area.

### **The No Action Alternative**

Under the No Action Alternative, DOS would not take ownership of the 31.7-acre portion of the former WRAMC and would not create a master plan to develop the FMC. DOS would continue to face challenges in facilitating the provision of adequate and secure facilities for foreign missions. The lack of readily available parcels within the District of Columbia for the development of foreign mission facilities would persist, and the high demand for foreign mission facilities would continue to grow. DOS's inability to reciprocally acquire properties in other countries would increase, and delays in updating U.S. diplomatic and consular properties abroad to meet modern security requirements would continue.

The No Action Alternative was retained for detailed study and the consequences of the No Action Alternative were fully developed for the year 2032 to demonstrate the full impact of taking no action. This provides a baseline comparison with the action alternatives. The year 2032 represents the earliest completion of the planned build-out of the FMC over an approximate 15-20-year period.

### **Alternative 7: Selected Action Alternative**

Alternative 7 was identified as the Selected Action Alternative because it furthers the purpose of the project and satisfies the needs for the project while best maintaining and enhancing the existing site character of the former WRAMC; addressing community concerns raised during scoping; minimizing potential impacts to cultural resources; and maximizing marketability by allowing the greatest flexibility in developing the site (Exhibit S.2).

The Selected Action Alternative would provide a maximum of 15 lots for chancery development. Two or three smaller lots would surround the chapel. This design compliments the urban development pattern planned by Children's National Medical Center (CNMC) and District of Columbia's Walter Reed Army Medical Center Local Redevelopment Authority for this zone of the former WRAMC. The design for this quadrant also allows for tree coverage and accommodates the vegetative buffer along Alaska Avenue. Green space would surround the chapel to maintain its setting.

The section of 14th Street north of Dahlia Street would be moved approximately 30 feet to the east to provide sufficient lot sizes in the northwest quadrant. The end of 14th Street is planned to terminate in a cul-de-sac centered on Building 54/Armed Forces Institute of Pathology's (AFIP) main entrance. Building 54, a historic district contributing resource located on the CNMC portion of the former WRAMC, is planned to be reused as a research laboratory. Access from the 14th Street cul-de-sac to Alaska Avenue would be through a 25-foot wide paved access path that would accommodate pedestrians and bicycles.

On the southeastern portion of the site, Building 40/Walter Reed Army Institute of Research, and historic Building 41/Old Red Cross Building, both contributing resources to the WRAMC Historic District, could remain for potential adaptive reuse, depending on marketability. During project coordination meetings, interest was expressed by foreign missions in reusing Building 20/Mologne House, Building 56/Fisher House No. 3, and Building 32/Wagner Sports Center, which are not historic district contributing resources. Several parcelization options under the Selected Action Alternative are provided to increase flexibility and allow for the reuse or expansion of these existing buildings.

Under the Selected Action Alternative, Dahlia Street and 14th Street would be developed as boulevards supporting pedestrian, bicycle and vehicular traffic connections to the surrounding neighborhoods. In the southwest quadrant, the boulevard landscaping bordering 14th Street would be widened to create green space. This low-lying green space along with tree boxes between the streets and sidewalks would assist with the filtration of rain water from the FMC,

Exhibit S.2 - Selected Action Alternative (Option C)





reducing stormwater runoff. Several parcelization options are shown for this quadrant to provide marketing flexibility and respond to foreign missions' expressed interest in reusing non-historic Building 56/Fisher House #3.

## **ALTERNATIVES CONSIDERED BUT ELIMINATED FROM DETAILED STUDY**

Six other action alternatives were developed during the alternatives identification process but dismissed from further consideration and detailed study. Alternative 1 (the DEIS Preferred Action Alternative) was dismissed from detailed study within the SDEIS because it was no longer viable given the change in total acreage required by the National Defense Authorization Act of 2015. Under the design for Alternative 1, the 31.7 remaining acres would have provided between four to seven chancery lots, which would be insufficient to meet the purpose and need for the project. Alternatives 1-6 are described in detail in the DEIS.

## **AFFECTED ENVIRONMENT AND IMPACTS TO THE NATURAL AND SOCIAL ENVIRONMENT**

DOS developed a study area of approximately 350 acres for the consideration of potential impacts to the social and economic environments in the area; a smaller area was used for the consideration of potential impacts to the natural environment. The study area not only covers the land that would be used for the Selected Action Alternative, but also the area that would potentially experience direct, indirect, and cumulative impacts from it.

### **Vegetation**

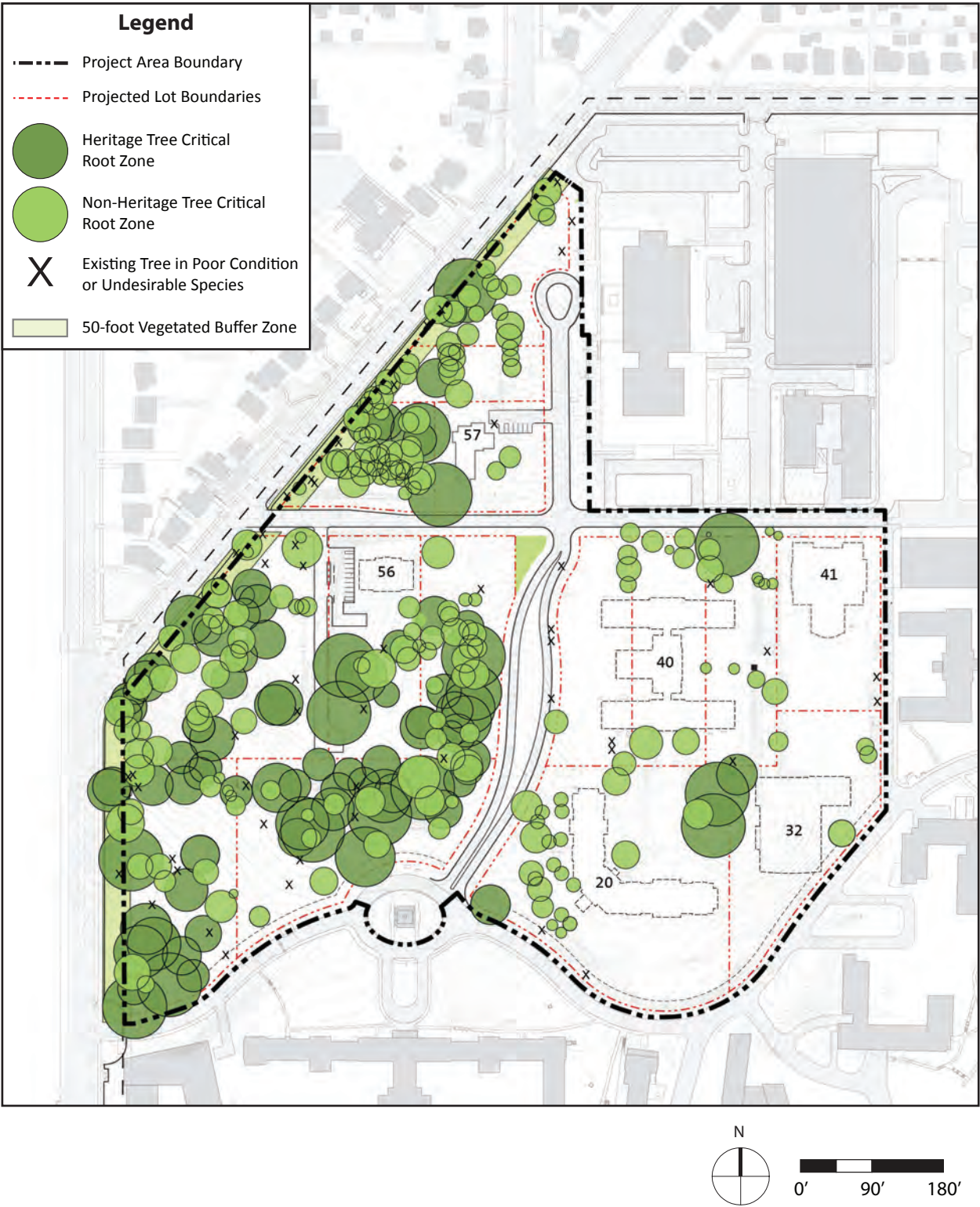
A detailed tree inventory of the area potentially affected by the Selected Action Alternative was performed; approximately 560 trees were identified, the tree sizes were recorded by diameter at breast height measured 4.5 feet above the ground. Approximately 84 trees qualified as Heritage Trees and 226 qualified as Special Trees (Exhibit S.3).

The No Action Alternative would not impact vegetation.

The Selected Action Alternative would impact vegetation by removing some existing trees, including Heritage and Special Trees. The impact to trees would be minimized by maintaining a 50-foot wide vegetative buffer along Alaska Avenue, Fern Street, and 16th Street. DOS would retain all trees in fair to excellent condition, including Heritage and Special Trees, within the buffer zone and the public open space. Approximately 15 of the 84 Heritage Trees and 47 of the 226 Special Trees inventoried across the site were designated as poor to very poor condition and would be removed. On the DOS-controlled portion of the site, if a poor to very poor Heritage or Special Tree is removed, replacement trees would be planted along streets and within the vegetative buffer to offset the loss at the ratio defined in the DDOT guidance. DOS would use a licensed arborist to identify necessary tree removals, protected trees, and to supervise new tree



Exhibit S.3 - Existing Trees



planting on the property. District statutes and Sustainable DC goals would be used as a general framework for tree management on the site.

Heritage Trees and their associated critical root-zone will be identified by DOS for each chancery lot. DOS would encourage foreign missions, through lot development guidelines and lease agreements, to protect, and if needed, replace Heritage and Special Trees in accordance with the intent of the Urban Forest Preservation Act. Requirements and guidelines for retaining the tree canopy on chancery parcels are included in the FMC design guidelines that are supplemental to the lease agreement between DOS and the respective chanceries (Appendix C).

The Selected Action Alternative would affect vegetation by removing maintained landscape and understory dominated by invasive species. Landscape guidelines for the DOS- and foreign mission-controlled portions of the site include the recommendation to use native or adapted species. The Selected Action Alternative master plan design guidelines require each street within the FMC to be lined with trees from the DDOT's Urban Forestry Administration recommended tree list (Appendix C). The trees will be located in tree boxes that would include bioretention elements in support of the stormwater management plan for DOS common areas.

## **Traffic and Transportation Facilities**

The streets in the study area are generally designed as a grid pattern, with a few roads that bisect the network diagonally. Intersections are at regular intervals and most streets in the study area provide two-way travel. The street network provides good traffic circulation throughout it, allowing for multiple routing options for drivers and dispersing vehicles throughout the study area. The primary streets in the study area are: 13th Street, 14th Street, 16th Street, Alaska Avenue, Aspen Street, Dahlia Street, Fern Street, Georgia Avenue, and Luzon Avenue.

On-street parking is provided throughout the study area along all streets. Most parking spaces require residential parking permits, though some spaces are metered or unregulated. Other on-street parking is generally prohibited during peak periods (typically 7:00 to 9:30 a.m. and 4:00 to 6:30 p.m.), but unregulated during off-peak periods.

The No Action Alternative would not impact access or parking.

Under the Selected Action Alternative, the primary vehicle entrance for the FMC would be at the intersection of Main Drive and 14th Street. Other vehicle entrances would be at the intersection of Alaska Avenue and Dahlia Street and at Dahlia Street. The driveways would be stop controlled. Access points where bus service is anticipated would be designed to Washington Metropolitan Area Transit Authority (WMATA) guidelines. Vehicular site access to each chancery would be designed to meet DDOT standards as described in the design guidelines for the site (Appendix C). A DDOT permit would be required to connect the FMC to the District's road network.

Each chancery would be required to provide a Transportation Management Plan (TMP) to be reviewed by DDOT during chancery design. The TMP would include Transportation Demand

Management (TDM) elements to recommend to chanceries to promote non-auto travel. TDM typically focuses on reducing the demand of single-occupancy private vehicles during peak period travel times or on shifting single-occupancy vehicular demand to off-peak periods or other modes of transportation. The implementation of TDM strategies for each parcel would be dependent on the needs and policies of the foreign government lessee. DOS would coordinate with DDOT to develop an acceptable list of chancery-level TDM elements.

The FMC Master Plan specifies that the majority of parking be provided in below-grade lots. Each foreign mission would be required to meet 100 percent of its parking needs within its lot at time of occupancy and at 10 years after occupancy. Existing buildings that are reused would be required to develop independent below-grade parking solutions and new buildings would need to incorporate parking within their lot in below-grade structures. Under the Selected Action Alternative, on-street parking within internal FMC roadways would not be permitted. Current parking allowances on internal FMC roadways would be removed upon implementation of the Selected Action Alternative. The parking garage associated with the CNMC exceeds the parking needs of the CNMC; therefore, excess parking spaces within the existing garage may be an option for additional parking.

The existing conditions in and around the former WRAMC were characterized to provide a foundation for assessing the transportation implications of the Selected Action Alternative. This was determined by examining the peak traffic hours. The “peak hour” represents the worst-case scenario, when the system traffic volumes are the highest. The use of a typical weekday morning and afternoon peak hours ensures that conclusions regarding adverse impacts and their respective mitigation measures would apply to the vast majority of the time the roads are used in the study area. Traffic counts were conducted at 13 intersections between the hours of 6:30 and 9:30 a.m. and between 4:00 and 7:00 p.m. on typical weekdays including normal operations of other major traffic generators in the study area.

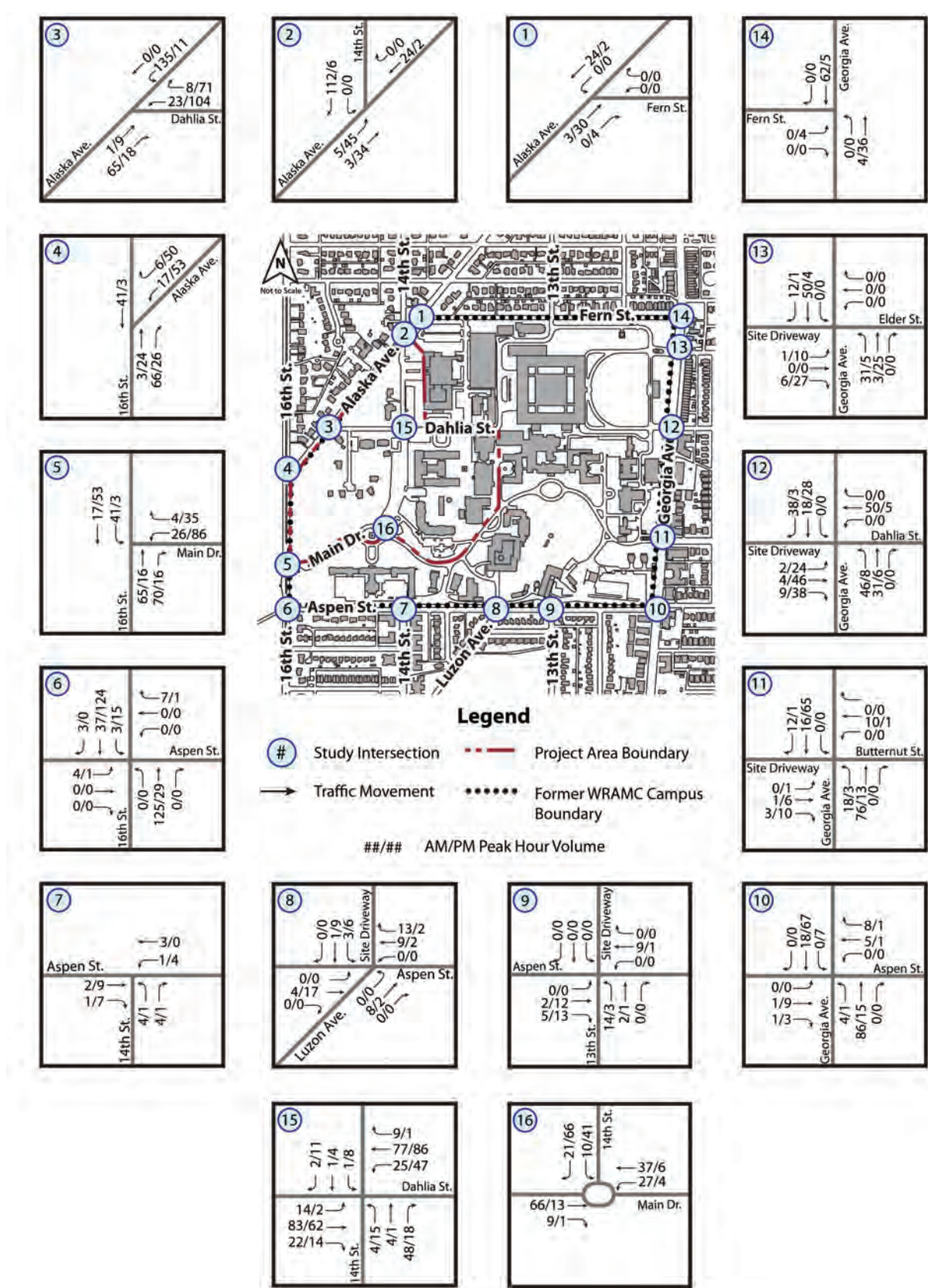
The No Action Alternative includes the traffic generated by other developments near the study area and inherent growth on the roads. Growth from these two sources was added to the existing traffic volumes to determine the traffic projections for the future No Action Alternative.

Trip generation for the chanceries was estimated based on existing traffic volumes collected adjacent to the ICC (Exhibit S.4). The traffic volumes for the Selected Action Alternative were calculated by adding the development-generated traffic volumes to the year 2032 for the No Action Alternative. The Selected Action Alternative was considered to have an impact at an intersection if the capacity analyses showed a level of service (LOS) of E or F at an intersection or along an approach with the proposed action where one does not exist in the future conditions for the No Action Alternative. Based on these criteria, the following intersections will be impacted by the FMC development:

- ◇ 16th Street & Alaska Avenue
- ◇ 16th Street & Aspen Street



Exhibit S.4 - Selected Action Alternative Generated Traffic Volumes (2032)



- ◇ 16th Street & Main Drive
- ◇ Georgia Avenue & Butternut Street
- ◇ Georgia Avenue & Dahlia Street
- ◇ Dahlia Street & Alaska Avenue

The Selected Action Alternative would result in a LOS E or F at the following intersections and approaches near the former WRAMC:

- ◇ 16th Street & Van Buren Street (both intersections)
- ◇ Georgia Avenue & Van Buren Street (eastbound morning and evening)
- ◇ Georgia Avenue & Fern Place (westbound morning and evening)

In each case where the Selected Action Alternative would result in a LOS E or F at an intersection and approach, signal retiming or changes in a lane approaching an intersection would improve the traffic flow at the intersection.

Heavy vehicle access to the former WRAMC, during both the construction and operations phases, would be restricted to Dahlia Street via Georgia Avenue or Main Drive via 16th Street. Given these access points, each of the driveways along Georgia Avenue and 16th Street would be required to be designed to meet DDOT acceptable standards for heavy vehicle accessibility including providing adequate turning radii, limiting visual impediments, and ensuring traffic does not oppose vehicles entering and exiting the former WRAMC. Service for trash, recycling, and deliveries would occur regularly. Chancery building design would focus loading/unloading operations away from public streets and major pedestrian accessways.

The No Action Alternative would not impact transit services.

The Selected Action Alternative would increase use in both Metrorail and Metrobus. Under the Selected Action Alternative, all through streets within the FMC would be able to accommodate buses should bus routes and/or stops be considered in the future by DDOT or WMATA. Most pedestrians accessing the former WRAMC arrive from adjacent residential neighborhoods to the north and south, bus stops along 16th Street and Georgia Avenue, or from the Takoma Metrorail Station. Nearly all streets in the study area have sidewalks, planted buffers between sidewalks and the curb, and on-street parking that provide an additional buffer between pedestrians and vehicular traffic. Existing deficiencies are along Aspen Street which provides sidewalks only in sections along the southern portion of the road and Luzon Avenue which does not provide sidewalks on the eastern side of the road.

The No Action Alternative would not impact pedestrian facilities.



Development on the former WRAMC would result in increased pedestrian traffic. Increased pedestrian activity along sidewalks and at intersections may warrant upgrades or changes to existing facilities to mitigate impacts.

The Selected Action Alternative would provide pedestrian walkways on federal government-owned streets. DOS would coordinate with DDOT to support the provision of pedestrian facilities at access points, including expanding sidewalk widths, removing obstructions, installing and upgrading crosswalks at intersections, and installing Leading Pedestrian Intervals and traffic calming measures.

The former WRAMC is served by an area with multiuse trails, signed bicycle routes, and local streets that accommodate cycling. The bicycle network generally provides good conditions for local trips and there are several routes for trips between the study area and Silver Spring, Takoma Park, and other destinations in Northwest Washington, DC.

The Selected Action Alternative would impact bicycle facilities by increasing bicycle parking and storage, as well as demand for Capital Bikeshare docks and facilities in or near the former WRAMC, new cycling routes, extensions to existing cycling routes, and increased safety and visibility for cyclists. DOS would design internal FMC roadways to accommodate bicycle travel, design shared-use trails to be 10 feet or wider, and provide land, installation, and first year's funding expenses for a Capital Bikeshare station on the FMC property. DOS would also fund the installation and first year's operating expenses for a second Capital Bikeshare station at the Takoma Metrorail station or in the adjacent neighborhood. Chanceries would be expected to substantially comply with District zoning regulations related to bicycle commuting.

## **Noise**

Noise measurements and concurrent traffic counts were conducted throughout the study area (traffic counts were updated in the spring of 2014).

The Federal Highway Administration's (FHWA) Traffic Noise Model (TNM), Version 2.5, which predicts noise levels at selected locations based on traffic data, roadway design, topographic features, and the relationship of the analysis site to nearby roadways, was used to model potential noise impacts for the No Action and Selected Action Alternatives. The percentages of automobiles, medium trucks, and heavy trucks used in the FHWA's TNM were developed from review of traffic classification data obtained during the noise measurement periods corresponding to the periods of highest noise levels.

Under the No Action and Selected Action Alternatives, noise levels in the study area are predicted to remain constant at Activity Category B (residential level) for most sites modeled. Noise levels are predicted to increase to Activity Category C (institutional level, e.g., schools and recreation areas) at 14 of the 58 sites modeled. The majority of the impacted receptors are along Georgia Avenue. These "increase over existing" noise levels were generally the result of normal traffic growth predicted to occur between 2012 and 2032. Therefore, projected noise impacts do not differ perceptibly between the No Action and Selected Action Alternatives.

Based on the amount of direct access along the corridor and limited right-of-way, constructing noise barriers is not feasible.

## **Cultural Resources**

The NHPA established a program to preserve historic properties throughout the country. Section 106 of the NHPA, as amended, requires that federal agencies review undertakings for their impact on significant historic resources. The term historic includes architectural, archaeological, and landscape resources. A significant historic resource is one that is either listed or determined eligible for listing on the National Register of Historic Places (NRHP). The NRHP is the federally maintained list of properties recognized for their significance in American history, architecture, archaeology, engineering, and culture. The criteria for evaluating the eligibility of properties for inclusion on the NRHP are established by the Secretary of the Interior.

When a historic district is nominated, the submission includes an evaluation of every structure within the district boundary and identifies each as either a contributing resource to the historic district or a noncontributing resource. The Section 106 process includes the evaluation of potential adverse effects on all contributing resources.

### *Section 106 Process*

Prior to the initiation of the current study, the closure of the WRAMC, under the 2005 Base Realignment and Closure Act process, made that undertaking subject to review under Section 106 of the NHPA. The Department of the Army Section 106 process was initiated in February 2010. An assessment was developed identifying the historic resources within the WRAMC and consulting parties were identified. This process included a series of public meetings between March and August 2010.

The outcome of the Army Section 106 process was a Programmatic Agreement (PA) executed between the Army, the DC-HPO and the ACHP (Appendix A). The PA, signed in January 2013, includes a series of stipulations that take into account the effects of the Army undertaking on the identified historic properties. With the November 2015 completion of the property transfer from Army to DOS, the stipulations in the Army PA that pertain to the DOS FMC property are terminated for the FMC portion of the site. A new PA based on the proposed undertaking by the DOS is being developed and could incorporate certain stipulations from the Army PA.

The Section 106 process for the proposed DOS undertaking was initiated in June 2012. The DC-HPO, ACHP, NCPC, Committee of 100 on the Federal City, APCWDW and National Park Service (NPS) – Rock Creek Park have been identified as consulting parties. DOS, with DC-HPO and ACHP, are preparing a PA for the undertaking and continue to work with and seek input from the other consulting parties (Appendix D).

### *Historic Significance of WRAMC*

The former WRAMC has been added to the DC Inventory of Historic Sites and the NRHP. The district consists of 41 contributing buildings (32 non-contributing) and 8 contributing structures (17

noncontributing), as per the accepted National Register Nomination. The Area of Potential Effects (APE) for the aboveground historic resources is comprised of the entire WRAMC facility and extends approximately 1,250 feet (four city blocks) to the north and west. It extends into Rock Creek Park along 16th Street, and is bounded to the north by Hemlock Street, until its intersection with 13th Street. East of 13th Street it is enclosed by Fern Street to Georgia Avenue in the east and Aspen Street to the south (Exhibits S.5 & S.6).

The WRAMC Historic District was added to the NRHP due to its significance in the field of military medicine and its architecture and design. The Walter Reed General Hospital, one of the oldest general military hospitals in the country, played a key role in the treatment and rehabilitation of America's soldiers in all major U.S. conflicts since World War I. The Army Medical School was responsible for training Army physicians in military medicine and public health and advancing military medical care through research. The AFIP is internationally renowned for its research on pathology and the study of disease.

The period of significance for the WRAMC Historic District is July 11-12, 1864 and 1909- 1956. The earlier dates relate to the Civil War Battle of Fort Stevens. The later period of significance begins in 1909, the opening date of the Main Hospital Building, and ends in 1956. The end date relates to changes within the military medical structure that resulted in similar or parallel installations being created elsewhere in the United States.

### *The Battle of Fort Stevens*

Fort Stevens was one of a protective ring of forts that were created around Washington, DC at the start of the Civil War. While Fort Stevens is over one-half mile south of the WRAMC site, there was battle activity that occurred north of what is now Aspen Street, the southern boundary of the historic district. The battle is the only engagement of the Civil War which occurred within the boundaries of the national capital.

### *Effects to Historic Resources*

The No Action Alternative would not affect historic resources. Over time, the No Action Alternative would result in the continued deterioration of historic resources.

While the property that is proposed to be used as the FMC is comprised of just a portion of the historic WRAMC campus, the primary historic resource against which effects must be evaluated is the entire historic district. It has been emphasized that effects must be considered for the historic district as a whole. A comprehensive evaluation process of the contributing resources within the FMC boundary was performed. This process was focused on avoiding and minimizing adverse impacts on historic buildings through reuse.

The Selected Action Alternative proposes some definitive actions that would result in adverse effects on historic resources, as well as potential actions where the effect would be dependent on whether DOS finds foreign mission partners that are interested in renovating a historic resource for a new programmatic use. The residential properties at the western portion of the site (Buildings 19, 21, 22, 25, 26, 29, 29A, 30, and 35) have been identified for removal. Buildings 40 and 41

Exhibit S.5 - Area of Potential Effect for Historic Resources

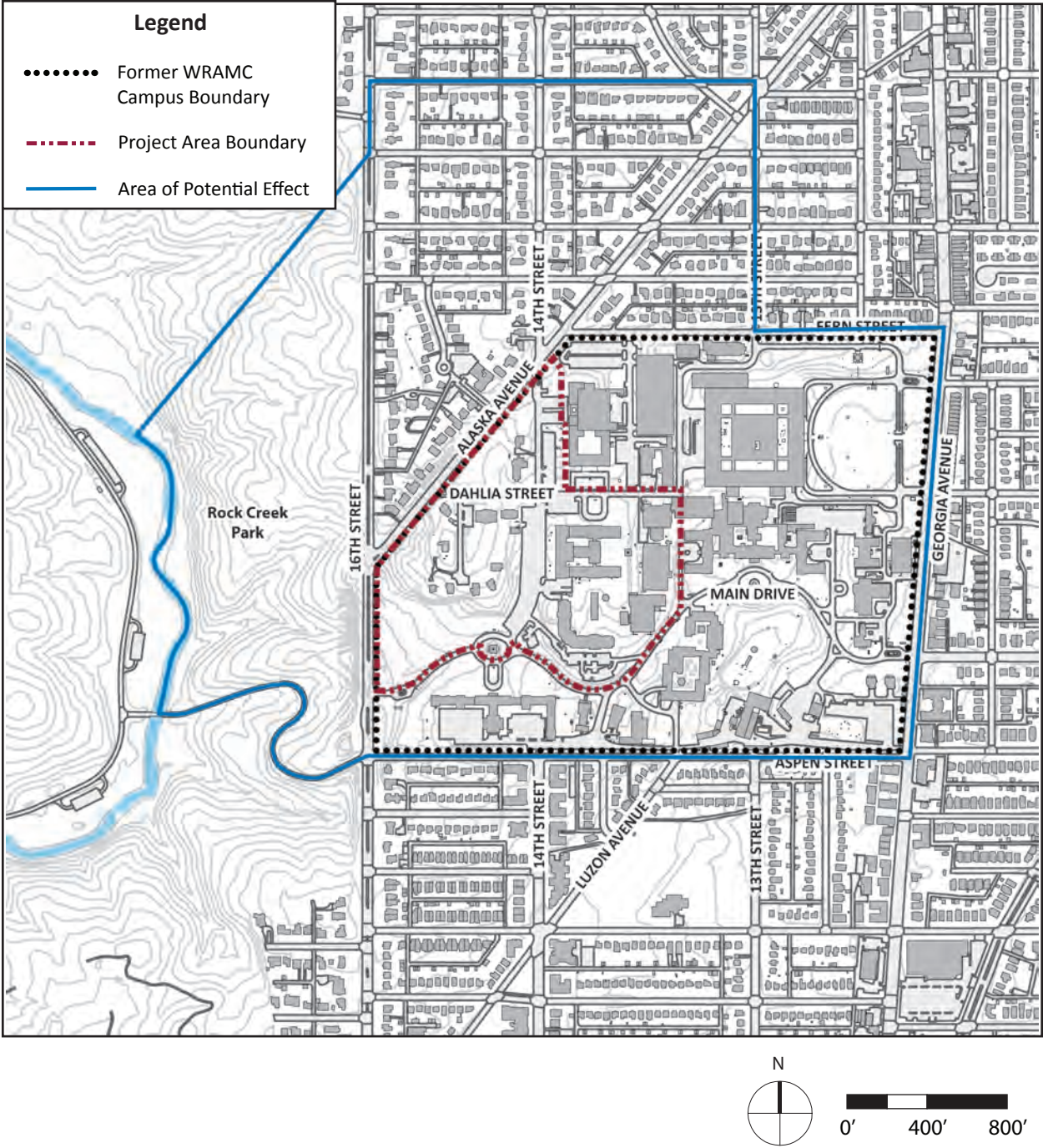
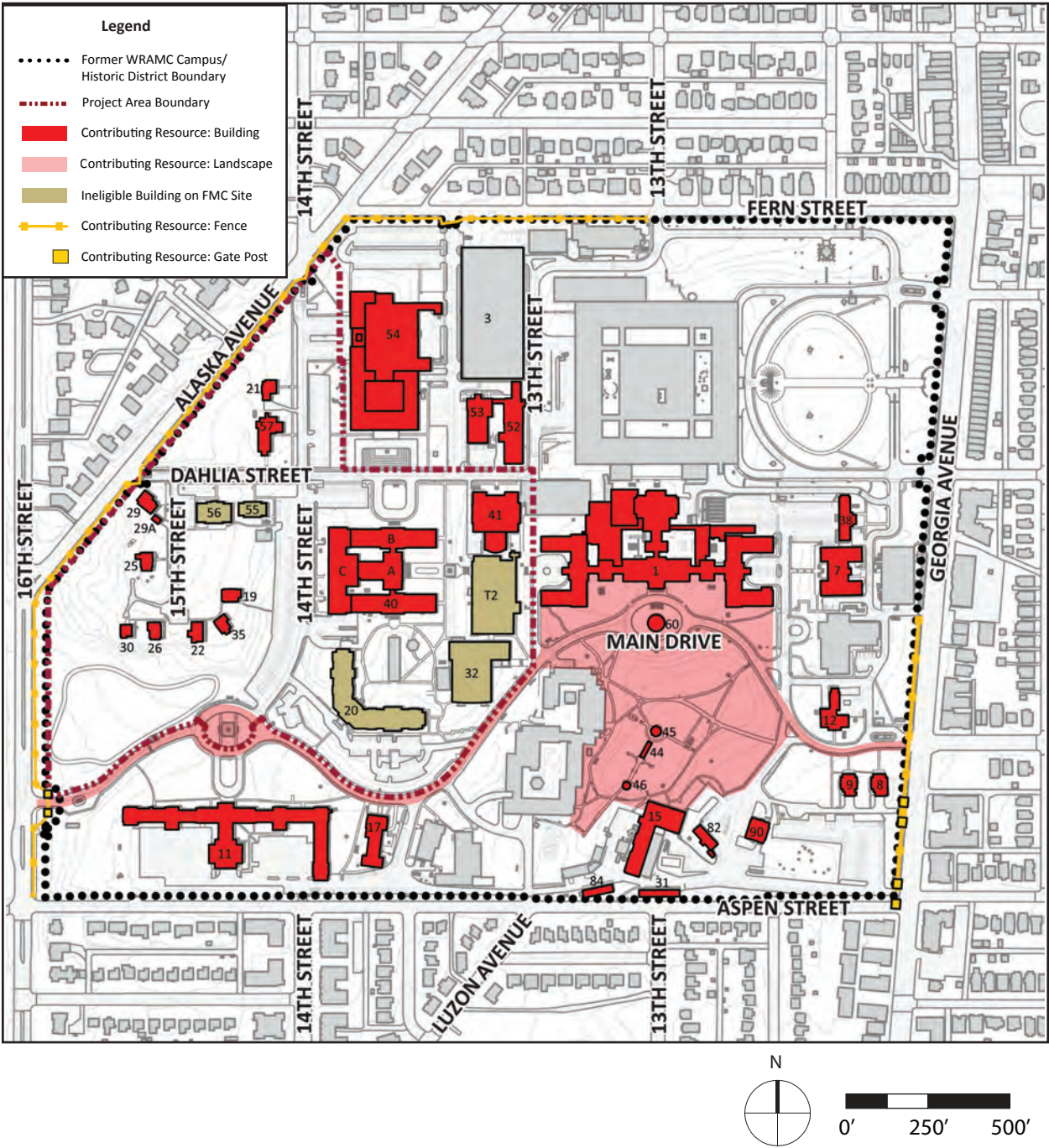




Exhibit S.6 - Historic Resources



will be offered to potential lessees with the objective that they will be renovated. Building 57 will be retained and repurposed with DOS retaining control of the building. The perimeter fence and gates will be retained, although some modifications may be required to accommodate current functional requirements.

Under the Selected Action Alternative, the “worst-case scenario” is that of the contributing resources within the FMC boundary, only Building 57 and the perimeter fence would be retained. The following evaluation is based on this scenario.

### *Rock Creek Park*

The Selected Action Alternative would have no direct adverse effect on Rock Creek Park. The Selected Action Alternative may have an indirect adverse effect on Rock Creek Park. The redevelopment of the FMC site by DOS (and the remainder of the WRAMC by other entities) will attract many new visitors to the property that may cross 16th Street NW to enter Rock Creek Park. While Sherrill Drive, located directly across from Aspen Street, offers vehicular access to the park, it is narrow and not safe for use by pedestrians except on weekends and holidays when it is closed to vehicular traffic. The closest pedestrian trailhead access points to the park are three blocks north (at Holly Street) and two blocks south (at Whittier Street). Lacking a safe entry point, some pedestrians may create unauthorized “social” trails through the woods which may lead to erosion and other damage to the park resources.

### *WRAMC Historic District*

Implementation of the Selected Action Alternative would result in an adverse effect to the WRAMC Historic District. The integrity of a historic district is based on the setting, design, and association of the component parts. These are linked to the identifiable boundary, the arterial system within the campus, and the surviving resources constructed between 1909 and 1956.

The boundary and arterial system would be retained and reinforced as part of the proposed undertaking. The Selected Action Alternative would retain and reinforce the primary vehicular artery of Dahlia Street (east-west). The section of 14th Street north of Dahlia Street would be moved approximately 30 feet to the east, and 14th Street between Main Drive and Dahlia Street would be modified to incorporate a landscaped median element that will also serve as a bioswale. North of Dahlia Street, 14th Street would terminate in a cul-de-sac centered on Building 54. The Alaska Avenue gate would be closed to vehicles, although pedestrian and bicycle access would be maintained. While these are changes from the internal road system that existed in 1956, they are in keeping with the changes that occurred throughout the period of significance and are not considered an adverse effect to the historic district.

The majority of noncontributing structures within the FMC project boundary would be removed to provide lots for new construction. Noncontributing Buildings 20, 32, and 56 may be reused, depending on interest from foreign missions. The siting, massing, and general design approach to new construction will be guided both by the guidelines issued by the DC-HPO for new construction in a historic district and specific design guidelines that have been developed for the master plan (Appendix C).

Removal of the residential structures on the west portion of the campus will have both a direct adverse effect, the loss of contributing resources, and an indirect adverse effect on the overall historic district. Removal would eliminate the buildings' historic location, setting, design materials, workmanship, feeling, and association with other historic district buildings. These buildings were not purpose built for WRAMC; they were absorbed as the campus grew and utilized as Officers' Housing. There is limited visual connection between these buildings and the core of the historic district, Building 1 (the Main Hospital), but they do represent an aspect of the history and development of the WRAMC.

The potential loss of Buildings 40 and 41 would be both a direct adverse effect, the loss of contributing resources, and the direct adverse effect on the overall historic district. Removal would eliminate the buildings' historic location, setting, design materials, workmanship, feeling, and association with other buildings within the historic district. While the history of the development of the WRAMC campus was mostly organic, driven by needs during periods of international conflict, the one planned formal arrangement on the campus that has survived is the relationship between Buildings 1, 40, and 41. The landscaped open space that was formed by these three buildings has been lost with the insertion of new buildings, but the loss of Buildings 40 and 41 would adversely affect the reading of the campus plan as it was developed between the World Wars.

The Selected Action Alternative provides for the reuse of Building 57/Memorial Chapel, but may have an adverse effect on the resource. The programmatic use of the facility has not been finalized. Prior to reuse, modifications would be required to comply with building code, incorporate programmatic needs, and provide necessary support spaces (toilet rooms, kitchenette, etc.). These modifications could have an adverse effect on character-defining features. Removal or replacement of features could have an adverse effect on the materials and workmanship of the resource.

The Selected Action Alternative may result in an adverse effect to the perimeter fence. The Selected Action Alternative retains the perimeter fence on 16th Street and Alaska Avenue within the project area boundary. Existing gates and gate posts at Main Drive (north side of the gate), Dahlia Street, and 14th Street would remain in their current locations.

The Selected Action Alternative would have no adverse effect on Main Drive. The Selected Action Alternative includes curb cuts to the northern edge of Main Drive for access to new construction. The configuration and detailing of the north side of Main Drive would not be changed.

### *Mitigation*

A set of design guidelines have been developed that are specific to the FMC development (Appendix C). These guidelines will work in coordination with the standard design guidelines that have been established by the DC-HPO for the renovation of contributing buildings or the construction of new buildings within a historic district.

Design review of the individual site developments by foreign missions will be undertaken by NCPC utilizing the process established by the FMA.

As part of the development plan for the FMC, DOS is offering both Buildings 40 and 41 for reuse. This effort includes the development of marketing materials that will be made available to interested foreign missions.

Mitigation strategies for historic buildings that are demolished may include documentation of the buildings prior to removal including historic research, drawings, and photographs in accordance with Executive Order 11593. This effort would build upon the documentation effort that was undertaken by the Department of the Army under their PA.

DOS will coordinate with the NPS on improvements for directional signage along 16th Street NW regarding access, vehicular and pedestrian, to Rock Creek Park.

### *Archaeological Resources*

The APE for archaeological resources is comprised of the 31.7 acres transferred to DOS at the northwest corner of the 115-acre WRAMC facility. It is bound to the west by 16th Street NW, to the northwest by Alaska Avenue NW, to the north and east by buildings of the former WRAMC, and to the south by Main Drive. The latter three boundaries (to the north, east, and south) are within the former WRAMC.

Seven known archaeological sites with prehistoric components are mapped within approximately 2,500 feet of the APE, all within Rock Creek Park. Due to these factors, undisturbed areas were considered to have a high probability for prehistoric and later archaeological deposits. A Phase 1A archaeological investigation was completed and a Memorandum of Findings submitted in September 2016 to the DC-HPO. The goal of the Phase 1A investigation was to assess the potential for the property to contain archaeological resources eligible for listing on the NRHP.

The results of the Phase 1A investigation indicated that soil profiles throughout roughly two-thirds of the current study area have been graded, cut, or otherwise truncated to such a degree that they have no potential to contain in-situ cultural material. Intact soils with the potential to contain cultural material in the upper profile were identified throughout the NW quadrant and across the central portion of the SW quadrant.

A Phase 1B archaeological study was conducted in the undisturbed NW and SW quadrant areas where construction or other surface disturbance will or may take place in June 2017. The survey identified one archaeological site and two isolated finds (ISFs). The ISFs, by definition, are not eligible for listing in the NRHP. In addition, the archaeological site discovered was recommended not eligible for the NRHP due to a lack of cultural features, near-surface context of recovered artifacts, and the existence of an extensive historical record on the Battle of Fort Stevens.

The No Action Alternative would not affect archaeological resources.

The Selected Action Alternative is unlikely to affect archaeological resources based on the results of the Phase 1B investigation. However, if unanticipated discoveries occur during the construction phase, DOS will appropriately identify, assess and, if necessary, mitigate adverse



impacts to the resource. DOS will include language in the lease agreements with foreign missions to manage unanticipated discoveries in accordance with federal law. Stipulations will be included in the PA for the treatment and identification of unanticipated discoveries within the APE. DOS will retain and display the recovered artifacts at the Memorial Chapel on the FMC campus.

## **Economic Analysis**

The No Action Alternative would not impact socioeconomic resources.

The Selected Action Alternative would have a slight positive impact on population and housing. The Selected Action Alternative would create a positive impact on employment in the regional economy.

The Selected Action Alternative would result in new employment both from the construction of the FMC and from operation of future chanceries. The jobs associated with the construction of the project are a one-time impact and do not represent an ongoing change to regional employment, while the jobs created from chancery operations represent a permanent impact to the regional economy. It is expected that the overwhelming majority of direct jobs would be filled by foreign nationals either relocated from current chancery facilities in Washington, DC or not previously residing in the country.

Indirect and induced employment would also result from the Selected Action Alternative. Indirect employment refers to the number of employees who are not employed by the foreign missions, but are jobs created or supported as a result of increased demand for goods and services as a result of the FMC's economic impact. For example, furniture purchased by a chancery would be considered an indirect impact of the project. Indirect impacts include induced impacts, which result when the earnings of construction workers and chancery employees, as well as growth in earnings at suppliers, lead to further sales for businesses that provide consumer goods and services.

As federal government property leased to foreign missions, chanceries would not generate tax revenue for the District. However, to the extent that chancery employees support study area retail businesses or choose to reside within the study area, the FMC would have a slight positive effect on study area tax revenue.

## **Security**

The WRAMC has been closed to the public since 2001. Under the No Action Alternative, the property would remain closed to the public and current security measures would continue. Under the Selected Action Alternative, public access would be maintained along all streets within the FMC except in limited instances where security justifies the need for temporary closures (such as national emergencies). DOS will define a process and establish thresholds for security-related street closures. Programmatic security planning would be developed. It is anticipated that security measures before, during, and after construction would be different and overlap in some cases.

Security requirements for the individual chanceries would be developed by each chancery and coordinated with the multijurisdictional authorities, with the ICC used as a security model. The U.S. Secret Service Uniformed Division is responsible for security of foreign missions and security requirements would include Secret Service patrols of the area.

## **Petroleum Tanks and Hazardous Substances**

Both the No Action and Selected Action Alternatives would represent a decrease in potential uncontrolled storage tank petroleum releases, as compared to when WRAMC was an operational Army Garrison, and no significant change from the current conditions.

Under the No Action Alternative, one underground storage tank (UST) and four aboveground storage tanks (ASTs) would remain at the site of the former WRAMC. The tanks are used to store diesel fuel to operate electrical generators. These tanks are double-walled and are continuously monitored for leaks by a leak detection system, except for the auxiliary AST Unknown 2 which is empty and is disconnected from the primary tank. The tanks would continue to be maintained in accordance with storage tank and air pollutant regulations.

The Selected Action Alternative would result in the removal of the storage tanks and decommissioning of the generators. If a building will be reused, the foreign mission would be responsible for removal and decommissioning. If a building is to be demolished, DOS would be responsible for removal and decommissioning. DOS will be responsible for removal of UST MP-30 that feeds a generator in Building 54. Through the design guidelines, DOS would ensure that all remediation is carried out in accordance with district and federal law (Appendix C).

Polychlorinated biphenyls (PCBs) were historically used in electrical transformers as a dielectric fluid and coolant at the former WRAMC. There are no known active transformers using PCB dielectric fluid and coolant. Historically, there were spills of PCB dielectric fluid and coolant that resulted in contaminated areas both inside the buildings and in outside areas. Several contaminated areas (PCB-impacted soils, transformer vaults, an interior basement floor, and transformer pads) remain on the property.

The U.S. Department of the Army (DOA) remediated PCB-impacted soils to meet a low occupancy area level of cleanup. Based on the available data, the PCB concentrations in some soils appear to be too high for unrestricted use; therefore, use restrictions need to be kept in place until either additional investigations and/or remediation are conducted such that it can be demonstrated the soil PCB concentrations in these areas are appropriate for the planned reuse. Groundwater was not encountered during excavations of PCB-contaminated soil. Under the No Action Alternative, the PCB impacted areas would remain in place.

The Selected Action Alternative would result in the removal of PCB-impacted soil and other materials. If a building will be reused, the foreign mission would be responsible for removal. If a building is to be demolished, DOS would be responsible for removal. Through the design

guidelines, DOS would ensure that all remediation is carried out in accordance with district and federal law (Appendix C).

Radioactive material was used in Buildings 40, 41, T-2, and the radiological bunker between Buildings 20 and 40. The U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission has released these buildings for “unrestricted use.”

Based on information provided by the DOA, asbestos is present in Buildings 19, 21, 22, 25, 26, 29, 30, 35, 40, 41, 55, 57, and T-2. The Selected Action Alternative would result in the removal and disposal of asbestos-containing material from buildings and steam tunnels in accordance with district and federal law.

Buildings 40, 41, 57, and T-2 are presumed to contain lead-based paint (LBP). The Selected Action Alternative would require building demolition to occur in accordance with LBP regulations. Buildings to be reused may require testing and remediation in accordance with the regulations.

## **AREAS OF CONTROVERSY**

Substantial public interest in the proposed action exists; however, no areas of controversy have been identified. Key issues of concern identified during the scoping process were incorporated into the development of alternatives and the evaluation criteria used to select the Selected Action Alternative.

## **ISSUES TO BE RESOLVED**

One issue would be resolved after the circulation of the FEIS: the completion of the process for complying with the NHPA Section 106. Consulting party meetings were held on February 26, April 2, May 7, and July 2, 2014; and February 23, and May 4, 2017. As a result of these meetings, a draft Assessment of Adverse Effects report and an initial outline and draft of a PA were developed. After further consultation with consulting parties and the public in 2017, these documents will be revised and finalized. Should archaeological investigations not be concluded prior to the execution of a PA, stipulations would be included in that document for the treatment of archaeological resources within the APE.